

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 7

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 8 7 4

♠ J 6

♥ K Q 10 8 3 2

♦ A 7

♣ A K 3



♠ 10 9 7 4

♥ A 5

♦ K Q 10 5 3

♣ 10 2

♠ K Q 3

♥ J 9 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 9 6 5

SOUTH's 2♥ raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦K

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 5 2
♥ Q 3 2
♦ 6 4 2
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ 10 9 7

♥ A 9 6

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ K 8 4



♠ J 8 6 3

♥ J 7 5 4

♦ A 8

♣ 5 3 2

♠ A Q 4

♥ K 10 8

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ A J 6

SOUTH has an ideal 1NT opening - 15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, NORTH knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since NORTH has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥3

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 5
♥ J 8 7 2
♦ K Q 9 6
♣ Q 10 7

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K 6

♦ 10 7 5 4

♣ 8 5 2



♠ A 9 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 3
♣ J 9 4

♠ Q J 6 4

♥ A 9 5

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 6 3

With 6 points, NORTH must respond to SOUTH's 1♣ opening bid. While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", NORTH should skip over the weak ♦ suit in favor of showing the 4-card Major ♠ suit.

SOUTH knows that NORTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2♠. With his minimum response hand NORTH passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
All Pass			
2♠ by North			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 4 3
♥ J 5
♦ Q J 7
♣ Q 10 7 3

♠ 7 5
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ K 9 4
♣ K 8 5 2



♠ K 9 8 2
♥ 6 3
♦ 10 8 6 2
♣ A J 9

♠ Q J 6
♥ A K Q 7 2
♦ A 5 3
♣ 6 4

With 17 points SOUTH is not strong enough to insist on game after NORTH's raise, but is strong enough to invite with a 3♥ bid.

NORTH, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
All Pass			
3♥ by South			
Lead: ♣7			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 5
♥ 6 5 3 2
♦ 10 4 3
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ A 8 3 2

♥ K 10 9

♦ A J 7

♣ K Q 6



♠ K J 7 6
♥ A 8 7
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 10 8 2

♠ 10 9 4

♥ Q J 4

♦ K Q 5 2

♣ J 9 5

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ 9			

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
♥ Q J 6 3
♦ J 10 2
♣ Q 10 7 6 4

♠ K J 8 4

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 6 5

♣ K 9 3



♠ 9 7 5 3
♥ 10 9 8
♦ K Q 9 3
♣ J 5

♠ A Q 10 6

♥ 5 4

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ A 8 2

With two 4-card Majors NORTH should respond
"up-the-line", bidding ♥s first.

Then, after SOUTH bids 1♠, NORTH has enough
points to jump all the way to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♠2			

Board 7

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 5
♥ K 9 8 3
♦ 10 4
♣ A K 4 2

♠ K Q 10 8 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 10 6



♠ A 9 6 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ A 9 6 2

♣ J 7

♠ 2

♥ J 10 5 2

♦ J 8 7 3

♣ 9 8 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣5

NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3 ♠, which NORTH is strong enough to raise to game.

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 3
♥ K Q 7 5 2
♦ 5 3
♣ Q 6 4

♠ 8 7

♥ 10 6 4

♦ K Q 10 9 6

♣ 10 7 3



♠ Q J 5 4 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 8 7 4

♣ K J 9

♠ A K 6

♥ A J 9

♦ A J 2

♣ A 8 5 2

SOUTH has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 6 points to SOUTH's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to NORTH in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥K			

Board 9

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 4 2
♥ 10 7 6 5 3
♦ 10 7 2
♣ A 3

♠ 10 9 5

♥ J 4

♦ Q J 8 3

♣ K J 7 2



♠ K Q 8 7

♥ 9

♦ A 9 5 4

♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ J 6 3

♥ A K Q 8 2

♦ K 6

♣ 10 9 5

SOUTH has a solid 1♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

SOUTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			
Lead: ♠7			

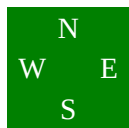
Board 10

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 4
♥ 8 6
♦ K Q J 4
♣ Q 9 5 2

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ 10 7 4



♠ 5
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ A 10 6 2
♣ K J 8 3

♠ K Q 10 7 3
♥ A 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6

SOUTH has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠, passed by SOUTH.

NORTH does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
2♠ by South			
Lead: ♥8			

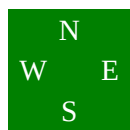
Board 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
♥ J 10 8 5 4
♦ 10 7 3 2
♣ A 9 4

♠ A 8 3
♥ A 7
♦ K J 9 6 4
♣ Q J 5



♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5
♥ 6 3
♦ 8
♣ 7 6 3 2

♠ K J 4
♥ K Q 9 2
♦ A Q 5
♣ K 10 8

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♠ 10

With balanced distribution and 16 points NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

SOUTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that NORTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 12

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K 8 5 4 3
♦ K J 4
♣ 10 6 4

♠ Q J 10 9 6

♥ A 7

♦ A Q 6

♣ A K 7



♠ A 8 7 2
♥ J 9 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ J 3 2

♠ K 4

♥ Q 10 6

♦ 8 5 3 2

♣ Q 9 8 5

NORTH is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

SOUTH does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

NORTH is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	1♠		
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 2
♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ 9 8 3
♣ A J 4

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ A J 4

♦ A 10

♣ 9 6 2



♠ 5
♥ 7 3
♦ 6 5 4 2
♣ K Q 10 8 7 5

♠ A K 9 6 4

♥ K Q 5

♦ K Q J 7

♣ 3

NORTH has a minimum 1♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

SOUTH hears the 1♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether NORTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

NORTH has two Aces so she bids 5♥ (5♣ would show zero Aces, 5♦ would show one Ace, etc).

SOUTH has heard enough and bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by North			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 8 3

♥ J 9 4

♦ 8 5 2

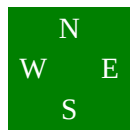
♣ 10 4 2

♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 7 6 5 3



♠ Q 10 9 5

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 9

♣ K Q J 8

♠ 6 2

♥ A K 8 7 6 2

♦ A 10 3

♣ A 9

SOUTH has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

NORTH, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

SOUTH shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which NORTH raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 2			

Board 15

North Deals

None Vul

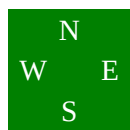
♠ A 6 5
♥ J 9 6 5
♦ K Q 8 4
♣ 10 3

♠ K Q 7 4

♥ 8 3

♦ 7 6 2

♣ A K Q 2



♠ 9 2

♥ K 10 2

♦ A 10 9

♣ J 9 8 5 4

♠ J 10 8 3

♥ A Q 7 4

♦ J 5 3

♣ 7 6

NORTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

SOUTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1 ♥.

NORTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and SOUTH again must bid. Since SOUTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2 ♠, which NORTH happily passes.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
All Pass			
2 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♠ 9			

Board 16

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 10 4
♦ Q J 9 5 2
♣ A 5 4

♠ A 9 4

♥ A 7

♦ K 8 3

♣ K J 9 6 2



♠ J 10 8 2
♥ 9 8 6 5 2
♦ 7 4
♣ 7 3

♠ K Q 7

♥ K Q J 3

♦ A 10 6

♣ Q 10 8

SOUTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

NORTH, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If SOUTH has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if SOUTH has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells SOUTH to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here SOUTH bids the slam.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♦ Q			

Board 17

South Deals

None Vul

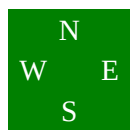
♠ J 10 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ A 8 5

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ J 5 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 2



♠ 5

♥ A K 10 9

♦ J 8 3 2

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A K 5

♣ J 7 6

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when NORTH opens 1♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			Pass
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
All Pass			
3♠ by North			
Lead: ♥K			

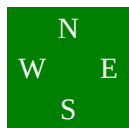
Board 18

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 4
♥ 10
♦ J 10 7 4 3
♣ 10 8 4

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5



♠ A 9 6 5
♥ J 9
♦ 9 2
♣ A J 7 3 2

♠ 10 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6

After SOUTH opens with 1♥, NORTH has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

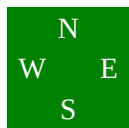
Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♠K			

Board 19
 South Deals
 E-W Vul

♠ A 6 2
 ♥ 9 8 5 4
 ♦ J 7 5
 ♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 10 8 3
 ♥ J 7 2
 ♦ 9 8 6
 ♣ Q J 3



♠ 9 4
 ♥ K Q 10 6 3
 ♦ 10 4 2
 ♣ A 7 4

♠ Q J 7 5
 ♥ A
 ♦ A K Q 3
 ♣ K 10 6 2

SOUTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit.
 With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1♦.

NORTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1♠.

SOUTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥K			

Board 20

South Deals

None Vul

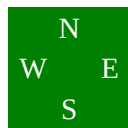
♠ 8 2
♥ 10 6 3
♦ 10 9 4 3 2
♣ J 10 2

♠ 10 9 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ Q 7

♣ A K 6 4



♠ A 5

♥ A J 9 8

♦ K 8 5

♣ Q 8 7 5

♠ K Q J 7 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ A J 6

♣ 9 3

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

SOUTH has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. NORTH isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. SOUTH has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. NORTH has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 21

North Deals

None Vul

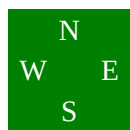
♠ 7 5 2
♥ 10 7
♦ 6 5 4
♣ A 9 8 7 6

♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 5

♦ A Q J

♣ K J 4 2



♠ A 9 6 4
♥ 9 8 4 3 2
♦ 8 7 2
♣ 3

♠ Q 10 8

♥ A J 6

♦ K 10 9 3

♣ Q 10 5

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

4NT

All Pass

4NT by North

Lead: ♥8

NORTH has a perfect 2NT opening hand, 20 points and 3-3-3-4 distribution.

SOUTH, with 12 points of his own, knows the partnership is borderline strong enough for slam. Since he is happy with Notrump, he invites NORTH to bid slam by responding 4NT.

With one more point NORTH might bid the slam, but here she just passes.

Board 22

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 7 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ Q J 2

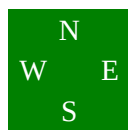
♣ A 5 4

♠ J 10 4

♥ A J 6

♦ K 5 3

♣ 10 8 7 2



♠ A 8 2

♥ 9 8 7 5

♦ 10 9 6 4

♣ 9 6

♠ 9 6 5

♥ K Q 2

♦ A 8 7

♣ K Q J 3

SOUTH opens 1NT with 15 points and a balanced hand.

NORTH, with 9 points, cannot bid game herself, but she can invite SOUTH to bid game if he has the maximum 17 point opener. So she responds 2NT.

SOUTH doesn't have maximum, he has minimum, so he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by South

Lead: ♥ 4

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

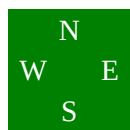
♠ A 6 4 3
 ♥ J 10 7 5 3
 ♦ 2
 ♣ J 9 8

♠ J 9 7 5

♥ 6 4 2

♦ A K J

♣ 7 4 2



♠ K

♥ Q 9 8

♦ Q 10 9 8 5 3

♣ 10 6 3

♠ Q 10 8 2

♥ A K

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q 5

SOUTH is 1 point too strong to open 1NT, so opens 1♣.

NORTH responds in his 4-card Major suit, 1♠.

SOUTH now shows her 4-card support plus her extra strength by jumping to 3♠ and NORTH bids the game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♠K			

Board 24

South Deals

None Vul

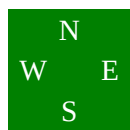
♠ 10 6
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ A 8 2
♣ Q 10 6 4

♠ 5 4 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 9 8 5



♠ A 9 8 7 2

♥ 9 6 3

♦ 7 4

♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q J

♥ K Q 8

♦ Q J 9 3

♣ A K 2

SOUTH has a classic 2NT opening bid, 21 points and balanced distribution.

NORTH knows that her 7 points will be plenty for game, but not enough to consider slam so she just bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥4